WEEKLY TRENDS
FOR SPC GLOBAL
ISSUE 4

WHAT ARE WE SEEING AROUND THE WORLD THIS WEEK?

Protein moves into soda.

Alli & Kahn
Eclectic innovation team

BellRing, the maker of Premier Protein, is taking protein into soda as shake growth slows. YESLY's sparkling protein water is now in about 500 Sprouts stores, and TikTok is mixing protein shakes into Diet Coke. Whey costs are not letting up, with Glanbia flagging more price rises. At home, Woolworths is reportedly retiring its Select own brand.

Week of 2–8 November 2026

144 SIGNALS TRACKED

8 MARKETS

19 PACK & DESIGN IDEAS

Act on this now

PROTEIN DRINKS · US

BellRing teases a Premier Protein soda

BellRing Brands is moving into soda-format protein drinks as RTD shake growth slows, and frames it as innovation to fight category headwinds.

Why it matters: The biggest RTD shake brand is moving protein out of the shake and into soda. That is the next format question for Stacked.

BevNET · Read the story

RETAIL · AUSTRALIA

Woolworths reportedly phasing out its Select own brand over two years

Woolworths is retiring its long-running Select store brand as part of a broader overhaul of its private-label line-up.

Why it matters: A private-label overhaul at Woolworths means shelf space gets reshuffled. Go into the next range reviews for Casa Coco, Stacked and Juice Lab ready to show why each brand earns its spot.

Mumbrella · Read the story

REGULATION · US

Poppi settles 'gut healthy' false-ad suit for US$8.9m

PepsiCo-owned prebiotic soda Poppi settled a false-advertising class action over unsupported gut-health claims.

Why it matters: Gut-health claims are now a legal risk, not just a marketing line. Any wellness or gut claim on The Daily Ritual needs solid evidence behind it.

ClassAction.org · Read the story

Beverages & coconut water

COCONUT WATER · FOOD NETWORK

Tom Brady's Good Nut coconut water launches via Gopuff

Celebrity-backed organic coconut water brand Good Nut launched in the US through Gopuff.

Why it matters: Another well-backed newcomer has entered coconut water. Casa Coco needs a sharp reason to choose it as the shelf gets busier.

Food Network · Read the story

PROTEIN WATER · FOOD & BEVERAGE MAGAZINE

YESLY sparkling protein water launches across Sprouts

A clear, carbonated canned protein water with 20g of whey and collagen protein and zero sugar, exclusive to about 500 Sprouts stores, with Amazon and TikTok Shop to follow.

Why it matters: Clear, fizzy and zero sugar is becoming the standard look of protein water. A useful benchmark for Stacked.

Food & Beverage Magazine · Read the story

HYDRATION · BEVNET / BEVERAGE DIGEST

Gatorade pitches hydration to non-athletes with Longer Lasting Gatorlyte

PepsiCo is reframing Gatorade as 'science-backed hydration for everybody' and has launched a longer-lasting electrolyte variant.

Why it matters: PepsiCo is selling electrolytes to everyone, not just athletes. Casa Coco's natural hydration story competes for that same everyday shopper.

BevNET / Beverage Digest · Read the story

SOCIAL · NEWSWEEK / HEALTHLINE

'Protein Diet Coke' spreads on TikTok

People are mixing protein shakes, often Fairlife Core Power, into Diet Coke. The trend has gone viral on TikTok and crossed into mainstream press.

Why it matters: Shoppers are already mixing protein and soda at home. That is demand for a ready-made protein soft drink.

Newsweek / Healthline · Read the story

Protein, dairy & yoghurt

PROTEIN COSTS · JUST-FOOD

Glanbia signals more price rises as whey costs stay high

Glanbia says it will keep raising prices while whey protein input costs remain elevated.

Why it matters: The whey cost squeeze is not easing. Lock in supply and pricing for Stacked and any whey-based drink.

just-food · Read the story

PROTEIN COFFEE · BEVNET

Free Rein launches its first RTD protein coffee, goes chain-wide at Walmart

Free Rein Coffee launched its first ready-to-drink protein coffee and expanded across all Walmart stores.

Why it matters: Protein coffee is getting chain-wide distribution in the US. A format to watch for Stacked or a dairy drink.

BevNet · Read the story

GLP-1 · FOODBEV

Lactalis launches Ratio Pro Fibre for GLP-1 users

Lactalis USA launched a yoghurt made for GLP-1 drug users, combining high protein with added fibre.

Why it matters: A major dairy company is now designing products for GLP-1 users by name. It backs this week's opportunity below.

FoodBev · Read the story

Retail & rules

M&S · GROCERY TRADE NEWS

M&S food sales jump 13.9% in the half

Food sales rose 13.9% to £5.16bn with volumes up 11.9%, food operating profit rose to £288.6m, and M&S put more than £50m into lower prices.

Why it matters: Premium own-label food is still growing fast in the UK, even while M&S cuts prices. A reminder that quality private label is serious competition.

Grocery Trade News · Read the story

PRIVATE LABEL · SPORKED

Walmart launches cane-sugar Great Value sodas

Walmart released four Great Value sodas sweetened with real cane sugar, styled on the premium 'Mexican soda' cue.

Why it matters: Retailers are borrowing premium soft drink cues for their own brands. Expect the same pressure on Australian soft drink shelves.

Sporked · Read the story

Pay homage to: pack & design

SUB-BRAND · PENTAWARDS

Coca-Cola builds one prebiotic sub-brand across Coke, Sprite and Fresca

Analogue designed a consistent prebiotic sub-brand and illustration system across Coca-Cola, Sprite and Fresca, each with 6g of fibre per can.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it with one shared 'functional' badge that works across several SPC brands without diluting each one.

Pentawards · Read the story

SINGLE SERVE · THE DIELINE

Poco Vino sells 2 million perfume-vial wine bottles in year one

Soft Machine designed Poco Vino's single-serve wine bottle to look like a perfume vial. It sold 2 million units across 12 countries in its first year.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it with a small, giftable bottle for The Daily Ritual shots that looks precious rather than medicinal.

The Dieline · Read the story

WELLNESS DRINKS · MINDSPARKLE MAG

Maison Somae turns wellness drinks into a daily ritual

Lentil Design Studio built Maison Somae's matcha and cacao drinks around a sun, horizon and wave emblem, warm earthy tones with one vibrant hero colour per product, and travel-style illustration.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to its system: warm base tones with one hero colour per flavour, a simple way to keep a wellness range calm and easy to shop.

Mindsparkle Mag · Read the story

Opportunity of the week

9 /10

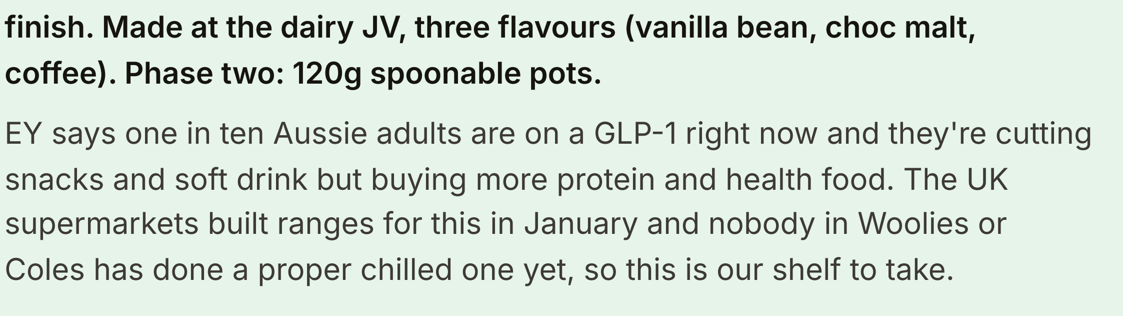
Small & Mighty: the GLP-1 mini-meal drink

$4.50 single · $14 4-pack

A 200ml chilled dairy 'mini meal' built for the 1 in 10 Aussies on GLP-1s and anyone eating less: 25g protein, 8g fibre, a stack of the micronutrients people miss when appetite drops, low sugar, small enough to actually finish. Made at the dairy JV, three flavours (vanilla bean, choc malt, coffee). Phase two: 120g spoonable pots.

EY says one in ten Aussie adults are on a GLP-1 right now and they're cutting snacks and soft drink but buying more protein and health food. The UK supermarkets built ranges for this in January and nobody in Woolies or Coles has done a proper chilled one yet, so this is our shelf to take.

Pack idea: Small, soft-edged squat bottle that looks deliberately smaller than a protein shake, with a 'clinical with soul' label: clean nutrient grid and one warm hand-drawn mark.



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Do the homework, then commit and go hard.

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